

Fine Motor Activities

Little hands grow strong through play, a few minutes a day is plenty.

CHILD _____

AGE _____

Pick a few activities that match your child's stage, then check them off as you try them together.

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Everyday Fine-Motor Helpers

build strong hands during daily routines

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Peel a banana or clementine at snack time | ☐ Zip, button & snap their own coat |
| ☐ Squeeze a sponge or washcloth in the bath | ☐ Open snack packages, lids & containers |
| ☐ Tear lettuce or snap green beans for dinner | ☐ Spray & water plants with a small bottle |
| ☐ Wind up toys, turn keys & twist knobs | ☐ Pick up toys with kitchen tongs (make it a game) |

Baby & Early Toddler

6-18 months

- ☐ Pincer-grasp puffs & soft cereal
- ☐ Drop objects into a bin, then dump & refill
- ☐ Stack 2-3 soft blocks
- ☐ Pull scarves from a tissue box
- ☐ Turn thick board-book pages
- ☐ Bang two blocks or cups together

Toddler

18 months, 3 years

- ☐ Stack a tower of 4-6 blocks
- ☐ Scribble & dot with chunky crayons
- ☐ Post coins or pom-poms through a slot
- ☐ Peel & stick large stickers
- ☐ Roll, poke & squish playdough
- ☐ Feed self with a spoon or fork

Preschooler

3-4 years

- ☐ Thread large beads onto a shoelace
- ☐ Snip paper with safety scissors
- ☐ Move pom-poms with tongs or tweezers
- ☐ Build with interlocking bricks
- ☐ Complete inset & peg puzzles
- ☐ Trace straight lines, circles & zig-zags

Pre-K & Kindergarten

4-6 years

- ☐ Cut along curved & zig-zag lines
- ☐ Hold a pencil with a tripod grip
- ☐ Lace cards & tie simple knots
- ☐ Button, zip & snap independently
- ☐ Draw a person with 6+ body parts
- ☐ Copy letters, numbers & their name

There's no rush and no "behind." Fine motor skills grow with playful, everyday practice, follow your child's lead and keep it light and fun.

Weekly Practice Tracker

Aim for a little each day, check a box every time you practice a skill.

WEEK OF

MINUTES/DAY

Tick off the days you practice each skill. Even five focused minutes counts, consistency beats length.

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Skill to Practice

MON
TUE
WED
THU
FRI
SAT
SUN

Pinch & grasp

puffs, pom-poms, clothespins



Cutting

safety scissors & scrap paper



Drawing, coloring & tracing

crayons, markers, lines



Threading & lacing

beads, buttons, lacing cards



Building & stacking

blocks, cups, bricks

Playdough & squeezing

roll, pinch, poke, squish

Self-care skills

buttons, zips, spoon, laces

Watch for These Wins

celebrate as they emerge

- ☐ Uses a neat pincer grasp (thumb + finger)
- ☐ Stacks a small tower without toppling
- ☐ Snips paper & cuts a straight line
- ☐ Holds a crayon with a tripod grip
- ☐ Threads beads onto a lace
- ☐ Copies shapes & first letters

Busy-Hands Basket

keep these on hand

- ☐ Chunky crayons & washable markers
- ☐ Safety scissors & scrap paper
- ☐ Playdough or modeling clay
- ☐ Large beads, buttons & shoelaces
- ☐ Pom-poms, tongs & tweezers
- ☐ Stacking cups, blocks & stickers

Notes, what we loved & what to try next
